A HALLOWEEN ONE-SHOT

# LANTERN NIGHT IN HALLOWBY

*For Don't Get Forked*

For 3–5 players and a Storyteller · 1½–2½ hours · ages 12+. Everything the Storyteller says is written out, to read word for word.



VERSION 0.2

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FOR THE STORYTELLER

# Before You Play

This is a complete evening of *Don't Get Forked* for 3–5 players who have never played. It teaches the game as it goes, so nobody needs to read the rulebook first, not even you. Read this page and the next before your guests arrive; everything after that you can read aloud at the table.

> **FROM THE DESIGNER**
>
> This is not a game where the Storyteller is trying to beat the players. You are creating room for chaos and letting the chaos take the table in various directions that will result in fun outcomes. The players dying is the fate of the dice, not the objective for running the game.
>
> *Richard Moore*

## How to Read This Script

- **Boxes marked "Read aloud"** are for the players. Read them word for word.
- **Grey, smaller text** is for you alone. It says what to ask, and what to roll or write down.
- **The Places** has a page for every place in town. When the party goes somewhere, turn to it.
- **When It Happens** has a box for everything the dice can do, from a Cost or Trouble to a chase, a capture, a Tell or the final flight. When it happens, turn to it and read.
- The rules here are the rulebook's, said in plain words. If you have the book, it agrees; if a question comes up that this script doesn't answer, make a quick ruling and keep the night moving.

## What You Need

- **Each player:** one each of d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12, plus a second d6 (the Mask) and a second d10 (the Monster), each in a different colour from the trait dice. A 0 on a d10 counts as 10. Players can share if you're short.
- **You:** a d6 (for Tells and chases) and this script.
- **The Entity cards**, one per Entity, from The Eight Entities near the end. The rulebook's defaults are already picked. Print them and cut them out, so players can choose. The Castle Duty can be changed at the table (Part One).
- **The tracker** on the last page, printed out. It keeps Suspicion, the Turns, the Lead, the shopping list and the lock-up, and a coin or a token on each track is enough.
- **The map** of Hallowby (Hallowby at a Glance). Print that page a second time, larger if you can, and put it on the table where everyone can see it. Players move a token or a coin to show where their Entity is.

## The Evening at a Glance

| | |
|---|---|
| **20–25 min** | **Part One: The Castle.** Who the players are, the shopping list, choosing Entities and Castle Duties, a practice roll. |
| **45–90 min** | **Part Two: Into Hallowby.** The raid: twelve Turns of sneaking, rolling, and maybe running. |
| **0–15 min** | **The final flight,** if the town turns out with pitchforks. |
| **5–10 min** | **Part Three: How the Year Went.** What came home, and the epilogue. |

If your group likes a break, take it after Part One, the natural pause before the raid.

## The Night in Numbers

Hallowby is an **Easy** town. Keep these to hand. They're on the tracker too.

- **The shopping list:** 4 items. One is **essential**, the cask of red wine.
- **Turns:** 12, then dawn. **Charges:** 3 for each Entity.
- **Suspicion:** starts at 0. The **Limit is 9**, or **8** with five players. When Suspicion reaches it, the whole town hunts the party in the final flight.
- **The way out:** Difficulty 6. **The lock-up:** Difficulty 10.
- **A local chase:** the Lead starts at 1, escape at 4, against a mob of 8 plus half the Suspicion when the chase starts (rounded down, at most 11). The chase raises Suspicion once, when it ends. It lasts 6 rounds at most.
- **The final flight:** the Lead starts at 2, escape at 5, against a mob of 10.

## Running a Turn

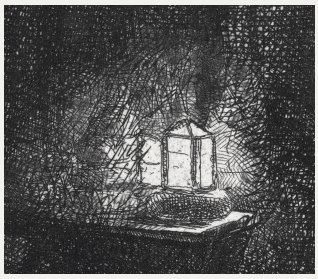
The raid is twelve Turns. Each Turn, run this loop. It is on the tracker too.

1. **Say the Turn,** as in "Turn 3." The marker moves at the end of each Turn, in step 5.
2. **Go round the table.** Ask each player, "What does your Entity do?" Each takes one action, which is to *roll* at the next obstacle where it is, *move* to another place, *pick up* dropped items, or *wait*. They act one at a time, in any order they like, and each result counts at once.
3. **A move** takes the Turn, and the Entity is there now. Turn to that place's page and read its arrival box. If it's a watched place that nobody has reached yet (for the way out, the first time anyone comes back to it; at the lock-up, a captive's arrival doesn't count), make a **Tell check** once everyone moving there this Turn has arrived. Not sure who else is coming? Ask before the next roll (When It Happens).
4. **A roll.** Ask which trait, Mask or Monster, and whether anyone spends a charge. Then they roll, you read the result, and you mark any Suspicion. **One roll raises Suspicion once,** by its biggest trigger (an overdraw adds its +2 on top).
5. **End of the Turn.** If the mirror has been taken and is still in town, Suspicion +1. Then move the Turn marker. If that was Turn 12, dawn comes (When It Happens).

Whenever Suspicion reaches the Limit, finish the roll's result first, then stop wherever you are and turn to The Final Flight. If that roll got the party out of town, they're out, and nobody runs. If it got someone caught, there's no local chase: they run in the final flight with everyone else.

### KEEPING IT MOVING

- Let the players plan out loud, but if a Turn stalls, ask the quietest player first.
- The party may split up. Hallowby is small enough to visit together, but splitting saves Turns.
- When a player asks "can I…?", the answer is usually "yes, if you get past the obstacle". Every place is in this script; nothing else needs a roll.
- Anyone with nothing to do, waiting at the bridge or in the lock-up, can voice a villager, such as Granny Mott, the constable or a costume contest judge.
- Be generous with the funny voices and stingy with the rules talk. The script holds the rules so you don't have to.



FOR THE STORYTELLER

# Hallowby at a Glance

EASY

## Hallowby *A market town that takes Lantern Night very seriously, and real monsters not at all.*

**Lantern Night:** Turnip lanterns in every window.

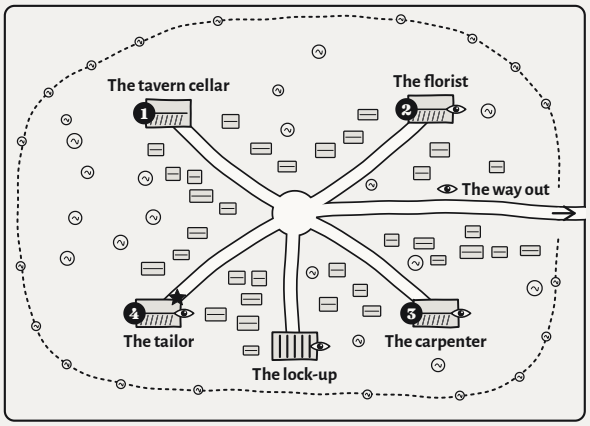
**The shopping list** (4 items):

1. **A cask of red wine ("for the guests")** (essential)
2. A pot of nightshade (purely ornamental)
3. Hinges that creak properly
4. A new cape

**The furniture:** a gilt mirror (Bulky: one carrier), at the tailor (4).

**Villagers:** old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before (carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade"); a gang of children (judging the costume contest).

**Easy:** Suspicion Limit 9 (8 with five players) · Difficulty: the way out 6, the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 10, Lead 2, escape at 5.




| LOCATION · OBSTACLE | | QUIET WAY | LOUD WAY | DIFFICULTY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** **The tavern cellar: a cask of red wine ("for the guests")** (food and drink) · **essential** | | | | |
| WAY IN | **A muddy yard full of geese** | Sly | Nimble (*run for it, honking*) | 6 |
| OR | **A heavy cellar trapdoor** | Brawn | — | 8 |
| THEN | **A dark, cluttered back room** | Wits | Sly (*rummage through everything*) | 8 |
| **2** **The florist: a pot of nightshade (purely ornamental)** (plants and seeds) | | | | |
| WAY IN | **A crowded shop floor *(group)*** 👁 ***watched*** | Sly | — | 8 |
| OR | **A rickety drainpipe** | Nimble | — | 10 |
| **3** **The carpenter: hinges that creak properly** (tools and hardware) | | | | |
| WAY IN | **A locked front door** 👁 ***watched*** | Sly (*pick the lock*) | Brawn (*kick it in*) | 8 |
| OR | **A high garden wall** | Nimble | Brawn (*through the gate, lock and all*) | 8 |
| THEN | **The night watchman on his round** 👁 ***watched*** | Wits (*time his round*) | — | 8 |
| **4** **The tailor: a new cape** (cloth and costumes) | | | | |
| WAY IN | **The shopkeeper behind the counter** 👁 ***watched*** | Charm | Sly (*snatch it from under her nose*) | 8 |
| OR | **A shuttered window** | Nimble | Brawn (*force the shutters*) | 10 |
| THEN | **A guard dog** 👁 ***watched for the piece*** | Charm (*a biscuit and a pat*) | Nimble (*outrun it, barking*) | 10 |

**Reading the key.** Each location's rows run in order: its two ways in (the party picks one the first time anyone tries the location, then keeps it for the night), then each "Then". *Watched:* Trouble there gets you caught. *(group):* each Entity rolls for itself. The loud way works too, at Suspicion +1 whatever the result. The guard dog's Difficulty is already 2 harder: it guards the furniture. On the map, an eye marks a watched location and the star marks the mirror. Every move takes one Turn (two carrying the mirror).

WAITING FOR ARTWORK



PART ONE

# The Castle

About 20–25 minutes. Have the Entity cards face up in the middle of the table, the map of Hallowby where everyone can see it, and the tracker beside you, set to Suspicion 0 and Turn 1. When everyone is settled, begin.

## Welcome

**READ ALOUD**

Tonight's Halloween, so tonight we play monsters. I mean real ones, the kind who have to dress up as people dressing up as monsters.

You all live together in a castle in the woods above a town called Hallowby. It's a draughty old pile that creaks in all the wrong spots, and right now the larder is empty.

Once a year the town holds its festival, Lantern Night. Everyone in Hallowby puts on a costume and walks the streets with a lantern till dawn. It's the one night of the year a real monster can stroll down the high street and get complimented on the outfit.

So once a year you go shopping, if you can call it shopping when you never pay.

You have until dawn to steal everything on the castle's shopping list and get it home. If it goes well, Hallowby wakes up a few things short and blames the children. If it goes badly, the whole town turns out with pitchforks and you run, and if they corner you, you get forked. Which is why this game is called *Don't Get Forked*.

**WAITING FOR ARTWORK**

## The Shopping List

Point to the four places on the map as you read each item.

READ ALOUD

Pinned to the kitchen door is the list, in spidery handwriting.

- **A cask of red wine, "for the guests".** It's underlined three times. This one is **essential**, because without it the castle can't have a good year. It's in the cellar of the tavern.
- **A pot of nightshade,** purely ornamental. From the florist.
- **Hinges that creak properly.** The new ones are far too quiet. From the carpenter.
- **A new cape.** From the tailor.

And someone else has added at the bottom, "Also, a mirror would be nice."

Bring home the wine and miss no more than one of the other three, and that's a good year, a **Win**. Do all that and bring home a piece of furniture too, and it's a **Grand Year**. There's a fine gilt mirror at the tailor's.

## Choosing Your Monster

Read the eight introductions, pointing to each card. Then let the players choose.

READ ALOUD

Eight monsters live in the castle. Each of you plays one, and no two of you play the same one.

- **Dracula,** the smoothest talker in the castle. He can look a guard in the eye and walk straight past. Garlic is his trouble, and he'd rather not talk about it.
- **Frankenstein's Creature,** the strongest. It breaks what others pick, and it can carry furniture like nobody else.
- **The Mummy,** the cleverest. It's three thousand years old and remembers every trick. Please don't tug at its loose threads.
- **The Werewolf,** the fastest. If the wolf shows, the crowd just sees a very large dog.
- **The Invisible Man,** the sneakiest. Nobody can catch what they can't see, unless he's carrying something.
- **A Ghost,** who drifts through walls and slips past crowds, though it can't stand cold iron.
- **A Witch,** the best friend to have at your elbow, because her spell makes anyone's roll better. Her black cat warns her when someone is watching.
- **Jekyll & Hyde,** two monsters in one coat. One's a charming doctor; the other's a brute who comes out when he shouldn't.

Pick one each and take its card.

If two players want the same Entity, they roll off (again on a tie): the high d6 keeps it, and the other chooses again. Once everyone has a card, ask each player in turn to say their Entity's name, so the table knows who's who. If asked: the Werewolf's very large dog costs a charge. Tonight's mirror is Bulky, so anyone can carry it, and the Creature's Tireless means carrying it doesn't make its Nimble smaller.

## Your Card

**READ ALOUD**

Look at your card. Every monster has five **traits**. There's **Brawn** for force and lifting, **Nimble** for climbing and running, **Sly** for sneaking and stealing, **Charm** for talking and passing as human, and **Wits** for noticing and working things out.

Each trait is a die. You all have the same five, a d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12, in a different order. Your d12 is what you're best at, and your d4 is what you'd rather leave to someone else.

Every time you roll, you add a second die. You choose which. Pick the **Mask**, a d6, and you keep your costume on and pass as human. Pick the **Monster**, a d10, and you let the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but if its number comes up higher than your trait die's, the town sees what you really are. That raises **Suspicion**, the whole town's alarm, by 2.

Suspicion is one track shared by all of you, and when it reaches 9 (8 if there are five of you), the whole town comes after you. Try to keep it low.

## A Practice Roll

Nothing in this practice counts. There's no Suspicion and no charges, and Jekyll stays Jekyll. Ask each player to roll their d12 trait with the Mask d6, add them, and tell you the total. Read the box as far as the Critical, tell each player their result, then read its last paragraph.

**READ ALOUD**

Every roll is against a number called the **Difficulty**, a 6, 8, 10 or 12. The bigger it is, the harder the roll. Let's say 8.

- **8 or more is a Success.** You do it.
- **1 or 2 short, a 6 or a 7, is a Cost.** You still do it, but something goes wrong, and I pick what.
- **3 or more short is Trouble.** You don't do it, and Suspicion goes up. If someone was watching, you're caught and you have to run.
- And if both dice show the same number on a Success, that's a **Critical**, and something extra good happens.

Now roll the d12 again, this time with the Monster d10 instead of the Mask. Did the d10 come up higher than the d12? Then the Monster showed. It usually helps you succeed, but tonight, every time it shows, Suspicion goes up by 2. The Mask never shows.

Let them laugh at whoever's Monster showed. Then go on.

## Your Powers

**READ ALOUD**

Each of you has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability, your **Signature** or your **Gift**, and both are on your card. Spend it before you roll. An ability never gets you past on its own; you still roll.

Almost every ability does one of four things. It makes your trait die one size bigger. Or it lets you roll a different trait. Or it lets you roll the Monster without it raising Suspicion. Or it opens a way past an obstacle that only you can take. Your card says which. Jekyll's Draught is the odd one out, because it changes his form. And when the town is chasing you, any ability can simply make your trait die one size bigger instead.

You can spend a charge on a friend's roll too, if you're in the same place. It uses your charge and leaves your action free. Only one thing can make a die bigger on any one roll, though. And if something makes it smaller too, the two cancel out.

Run out of charges and you can still use an ability. That's an **overdraw**. Instead of a charge, it costs Suspicion +2, on top of anything else the roll raises.

Your **Perk** is always on, and free. When the mob is chasing you, it brings your **Weakness** along. And your **Tell** is the little thing that gives you away. Tonight, keep the Gift and Perk your card shows.

## Castle Duties

READ ALOUD

Last thing. Everyone at the castle has a job, a **Castle Duty**, and does the shopping for it. At the place where your Duty's item is, your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls there.

Tonight's list needs a **Cook** for the wine, a **Gardener** for the nightshade, a **Handyman** for the hinges and a **Tailor** for the cape. The Butler and the Librarian have nothing to buy tonight.

Your card has a Duty already. Keep it, or swap to any Duty nobody else has. No two of you can have the same one.

If two players want the same Duty, they roll off (again on a tie): the high d6 keeps it, and the other picks another. Write each player's Duty on the tracker. The six Duties are Cook, Gardener, Librarian, Butler, Handyman and Tailor.

## Setting Off

READ ALOUD

The castle door groans open. Down the hill, between the trees, Hallowby is glowing. There's a turnip lantern in every window and music in the square, and somewhere a bell is ringing for no reason at all.

You straighten your costumes, which is to say, yourselves.

Let's go shopping.

Turn to Part Two.





PART TWO

# Into Hallowby

About 45–90 minutes, plus the final flight if it comes. Read the next two boxes, then start Turn 1.

## The Edge of Town

READ ALOUD

The path comes out of the woods at the bottom of the hill, by a little humpbacked bridge. That bridge is your **way out**. When it's time to go home, you all meet back here.

Across it, Hallowby is in full swing. Turnip lanterns grin from every window, and in the square a fiddle band is murdering a jig. Children dressed as bats chase children dressed as ghosts. An old woman with a lantern and a pitchfork, "for the parade", gives you a long look, and decides you're in costume.

You're in.

## How the Night Works

READ ALOUD

The night lasts **12 Turns**. When the twelfth is over, the sun comes up.

Each Turn, each of you does one thing. You can **roll** to get past something, **move** to another place, **pick up** something that was dropped, or **wait**. You go one at a time, in any order you like, and everything happens straight away. You can split up.

Moving anywhere on the map takes one Turn. There are the four places on the list, the lock-up, and the bridge.

Every place on the list has **obstacles**, say a locked door or a nosy shopkeeper. You get past them in order, and whoever gets past the last one has the item. Each obstacle tells you which traits work and how hard it is.

Every place on the list has **two ways in**. The first time any of you tries a place, you choose one, and that's your way in there for the rest of the night.

Once one of you gets past an obstacle, it stays beaten for everybody, with two exceptions. Everyone gets past a crowd for themselves, and a way that only you can take (your card says when) is beaten only for you.

Some obstacles have a **loud way**. It works, but it puts Suspicion up by 1, whatever you roll.

Some obstacles are **watched**. Get Trouble at a watched one and you're caught, which means you run for it. If the crowd corners you, you go in the lock-up, and the others can get you out.

The first time any of you reaches a watched place (the bridge counts when you come back to it), I roll a die to see whether a Tell gives you away. That's Suspicion +1.

You can hand things to each other any time you're in the same place, and you can carry as much as you like. The mirror is the exception, because it's furniture, and furniture is heavy.

When you're done, everyone not locked up meets at the bridge, and one of you rolls to get you all out of town.

And remember Suspicion. If it reaches **9** (8 if there are five of you), or you're still in town when the sun comes up, the whole town hunts you, and you run for the castle together. That's the **final flight**, and it's how monsters get forked.

Then begin.

**READ ALOUD**

It's **Turn 1**. Where do you go?

If they can't decide, the tavern cellar makes a gentle first stop, since nothing there is watched and it has the essential. Turn to The Places for wherever they go.

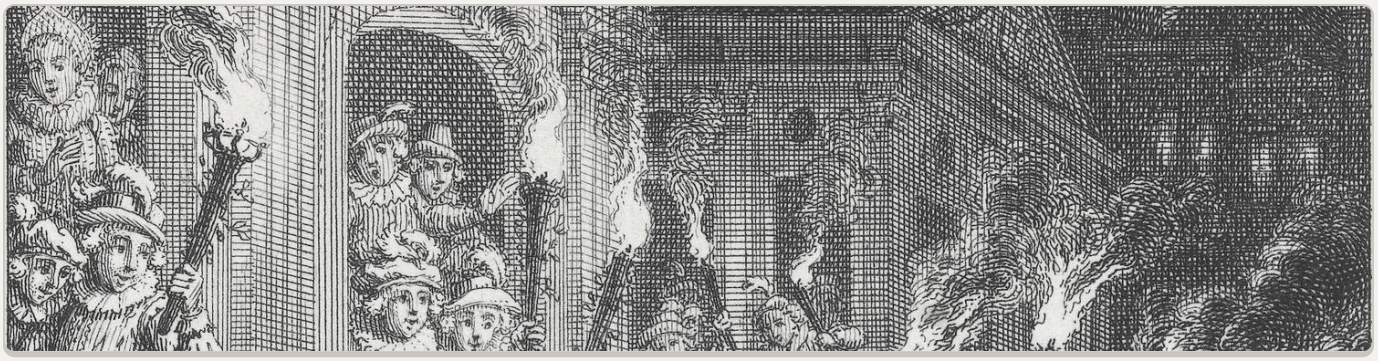
**YOUR FIRST ROLL: WALK THEM THROUGH IT**

1. **The first time anyone tries a place,** ask "Which way in?" Read both, then they choose.
2. **"Which trait?"** Only a trait the obstacle lists, unless an ability says otherwise. Read them the choices.
3. **"Mask or Monster?"**
4. **"Is anyone spending a charge?"** Ask before the roll. The charge can be theirs or a friend's at the same place.
5. **Castle Duty.** If this place has the item for the roller's Duty, their trait die is one size bigger (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 stays a d12). That's the roll's one bigger die, so no ability can add another.
6. **Bigger and smaller.** If something also makes the die smaller (a Cost, a Weakness, carrying the mirror unless you're the Creature), cancel them one for one first, so a d12 made bigger and smaller stays a d12. Then no die goes below a d4 or above a d12.
7. **Roll and add,** and compare with the Difficulty to see if it's a Success, a Cost (1–2 short) or Trouble (3 or more short). Doubles on a Success make a Critical.
8. **Suspicion.** The loud way +1, Trouble +1, the Monster shows +2. One roll raises it once, by its biggest, so the loud way and the Monster showing make +2, not +3. An overdraw is the exception: its +2 goes on top.
9. **Read the result's line** from the obstacle. For a Cost or Trouble, turn to When It Happens.

## What Raises Suspicion

| | |
|---|---|
| **Trouble** | +1 |
| **The Monster shows** | +2 |
| **Taking the loud way** | +1, whatever the result |
| **A Cost picked as Suspicion** | +1 |
| **Overdraw** | +2, on top of the roll's other rise |
| **A Tell goes off** | +1 (not from a roll) |
| **The mirror, once taken** | +1 at the end of every Turn, even set down, until it leaves town, is lost or is abandoned |

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger, and an overdraw adds +2 on top. A local chase raises it once, when the chase ends. Good results never lower it. It never goes past the Limit, and reaching it starts the final flight at once.



PART TWO

# The Places

One page for each place on the map. When anyone arrives, read the arrival box. The first time anyone tries a location, read both ways in and let them choose; a try by a way of an Entity's own picks one too. They keep that way in for the night, so after that, just say which way the party took. Each obstacle has its own box. Read it, then the roll line, then the line for the result. For a Cost, Trouble or anything else the dice do, turn to When It Happens. Each obstacle's Success line is for the quiet way; where the loud way was taken, read its own line if it has one. When an ability opened a way of its own, say how it went in a line of your own. On a later arrival, leave out anything already taken.

## 1 • The Tavern Cellar

**The cask of red wine** (essential) · food and drink, so the **Cook's** trait die is one size bigger here · **nothing here is watched**, so no Tell check and nobody gets caught here.

> READ ALOUD
>
> The Grinning Turnip is the loudest building in Hallowby tonight, all fiddles and singing, with a queue out of the door. Nobody, of course, is looking round the back.
>
> Behind the tavern, a muddy yard full of geese leads to the kitchen door. In the alley beside it, a heavy trapdoor drops to the cellar. Which way?

### WAY IN · THE GOOSE YARD

> READ ALOUD
>
> The yard is ankle-deep in mud and full of geese. Geese are the worst guards in the world, or the best, depending which side of them you're on.

**Sly to tiptoe through. Or Nimble, the loud way: run for it, honking. Difficulty 6. Not watched.**

**Success:** You cross the whole yard without a single honk. The kitchen door is on the latch, and the cellar steps are right inside.

**Success, the loud way:** You charge through in a storm of feathers. Every goose in Hallowby knows your face now, but you're in.

**Trouble:** One goose sees you, and then, as geese do, all of them see you. You back out of the yard, covered in mud, to a chorus of honking. (Suspicion +1. Nobody is watching, so no chase.)

**OR WAY IN · THE CELLAR TRAPDOOR**

> READ ALOUD
>
> In the alley, an oak trapdoor, iron-bound and as heavy as a coffin lid.

**Brawn. Difficulty 8. Not watched.**

**Success:** It lifts with a groan nobody hears over the fiddles. Steps lead down into the dark.

**Trouble:** It won't budge, and something in your back goes *ping*. (Suspicion +1. No chase.)

**THEN · THE BACK ROOM**

> READ ALOUD
>
> The cellar is one dark, cluttered back room, full of barrels and sacks and a broken mangle and forty years of things nobody threw away. The wine is in here somewhere.

**Wits to work out which barrel. Or Sly, the loud way: rummage through everything. Difficulty 8. Not watched.**

**Success:** There, behind the pickled onions, is a small cask with a faded red label. *For the guests.*

**Trouble:** You bring down a shelf of saucepans. Upstairs, the fiddles stop. There's a long pause, and then, thank goodness, they start up again. (Suspicion +1. No chase.)

> READ ALOUD
>
> Whoever got past the back room is holding the cask of red wine, and the essential is yours.

Mark the wine on the tracker, with who carries it.

## 2 · The Florist

**The pot of nightshade** · plants and seeds, so the **Gardener's** trait die is one size bigger here · **watched**, so the first time anyone arrives, make a Tell check once everyone moving here this Turn has arrived (When It Happens).

> READ ALOUD
>
> Mrs Thorne, the florist, is selling festival garlands as fast as she can wrap them. The shop floor is packed with people in costume, and from behind the till she sees every one of them.
>
> The nightshade sits on a high shelf at the back. Up the side wall, a rickety drainpipe runs to an open window just above that shelf. Which way?

**WAY IN · THE CROWDED SHOP FLOOR** GROUP · WATCHED

> READ ALOUD
>
> Wall-to-wall witches, skeletons and one very hot man in a bear suit, all queuing for garlands.

**Sly to slip through the crowd. Difficulty 8. Watched. It's a crowd: each of you who wants past rolls for yourself. Whoever gets through takes the pot; if several get through at once, you choose who.**

**Success:** A bit of elbow, a lot of "pardon me", and the nightshade is in your hands.

**Trouble:** Someone treads on your foot. You yelp, in a voice that isn't quite human, and the whole shop turns round. "Thief!" (Suspicion +1, and caught in a local chase.)

If two or more roll the crowd in the same Turn, that's a **group check** (When It Happens). A Ghost with its Spectral Perk isn't stopped by the crowd, a group way in. It walks through with no roll and no action, even in the Turn it arrives, and takes the pot (unless it's already carrying something).

**OR WAY IN · THE DRAINPIPE**

> READ ALOUD
> The alley beside the shop is empty. The drainpipe is held to the wall with three rusty brackets and a prayer.

**Nimble to climb it. Difficulty 10. Not watched.**

**Success:** Up, in through the window, and the nightshade is right there on the shelf.

**Trouble:** The drainpipe comes away from the wall with you still on it, and you land in a water butt. (Suspicion +1. No chase.)

> READ ALOUD
> Whoever got through has the pot of nightshade, purely ornamental, of course.

## 3 · The Carpenter

**Hinges that creak properly** · tools and hardware, so the **Handyman's** trait die is one size bigger here · **watched**, with a Tell check on the first arrival.

> READ ALOUD
> The carpenter's workshop is shut for the festival. The lane outside is busy with families heading for the square, and every few minutes the night watchman's lantern comes bobbing past on his round.
>
> The front door is locked. Round the back, a high garden wall hides the timber yard. Through the window you can see the hinges, hanging on a board above the workbench. Which way?

**WAY IN · THE FRONT DOOR** WATCHED

> READ ALOUD
> A stout front door with a good lock, in full view of the lane.

**Sly to pick the lock. Or Brawn, the loud way: kick it in. Difficulty 8. Watched.**

**Success:** Click. The door swings open on hinges that, tragically, don't creak at all.

**Success, the loud way:** One kick and the door is in, with you right behind it.

**Trouble:** The lock holds, and a man dressed as a pumpkin asks what you think you're doing. (Suspicion +1, and caught in a local chase.)

**OR WAY IN · THE GARDEN WALL**

> READ ALOUD
> A high brick wall with broken glass along the top, and a padlocked gate.

**Nimble to climb it. Or Brawn, the loud way: through the gate, lock and all. Difficulty 8. Not watched.**

**Success:** You drop over the wall among the timber stacks, and would you believe it, the back door isn't even locked.

**Success, the loud way:** The gate, lock and all, lies flat among the timber stacks.

**Trouble:** Halfway up, the top of the wall comes away in your hands. (Suspicion +1. No chase.)

**Trouble, the loud way:** The gate, lock and all, doesn't budge. (Suspicion +1. No chase.)

**THEN · THE NIGHT WATCHMAN** WATCHED

> READ ALOUD
>
> You're inside, but the workbench is right under the front window, and here comes the watchman's lantern again.

**Wits to time his round. Difficulty 8. Watched.**

**Success:** The lantern swings left, then right, and now you go. By the time he looks in, the board is empty and so is the room.

**Trouble:** He comes back early, and the lantern swings round to you. "Oi!" (Suspicion +1, and caught in a local chase.)

> READ ALOUD
>
> Whoever got past the watchman has the hinges. Hear how beautifully they creak?

## 4 • The Tailor

**A new cape** · cloth and costumes, so the **Tailor's** trait die is one size bigger here, the guard dog included · **watched**, with a Tell check on the first arrival · **the mirror** is here.

> READ ALOUD
>
> The tailor's shop is lit up like a stage. Mrs Pinch, the tailor, stands behind her counter with a mouthful of pins, ready for last-minute repairs. The costume contest judges, a gang of very serious children, are due any minute.
>
> The new cape hangs on a stand behind her. The side window is shuttered. And at the back of the shop, beside a tall gilt mirror, an enormous dog is asleep, at least for now. Which way?

**WAY IN · MRS PINCH AT THE COUNTER** WATCHED

> READ ALOUD
>
> Mrs Pinch looks you up and down, and takes the pins out of her mouth.

**Charm to talk her round. Or Sly, the loud way: snatch it from under her nose. Difficulty 8. Watched.**

**Success:** You need it for the costume contest, you explain. She is so pleased someone appreciates a good cape that she wraps it for you.

**Success, the loud way:** You snatch the cape and you're gone before the pins hit the floor.

**Trouble:** She peers at you over her spectacles. "That's not a costume, dear," she says. "That's a face." (Suspicion +1, and caught in a local chase.)

**OR WAY IN · THE SHUTTERED WINDOW**

> READ ALOUD
>
> A side window in a dark passage, its shutters latched on the inside.

**Nimble to slip the catch and climb in. Or Brawn, the loud way: force the shutters. Difficulty 10. Not watched.**

**Success:** The catch lifts with a fingernail. In, out, and the cape is over your arm.

**Success, the loud way:** The shutters give with a bang, and you're in.

**Trouble:** The shutter swings back and bangs like a gunshot. Mrs Pinch drops her pins. (Suspicion +1, but no chase, because nobody saw who.)

READ ALOUD

Whoever got in has the new cape.

## The Mirror

Once the cape has been taken, anyone at the tailor's may try for the mirror (if the way in was a way only one of them could take, only that one). Taking it, once they're past the dog, is free. Before anyone takes it, count aloud. From the Turn it's taken, it adds Suspicion +1 at the end of every Turn until it leaves town, usually 2 in all if it goes straight to the bridge, so warn them if it would reach the Limit.

**THEN · THE GUARD DOG** WATCHED · FOR THE MIRROR

READ ALOUD

The dog is the size of a small pony, and it's lying across the mirror's feet. As you watch, one eye opens.

**Charm: a biscuit and a pat. Or Nimble, the loud way: outrun it, barking. Difficulty 10 (it's guarding the furniture). Watched.**

**Success:** The dog thumps its tail twice, rolls over, and lets you have the mirror.

**Success, the loud way:** You bolt past with the dog at your heels; by the time it skids to a stop, the mirror is yours.

**Trouble:** The dog wakes up all at once, and all of it barks. (Suspicion +1, and caught in a local chase.)

Read this when someone takes the mirror. If it's the Creature, leave out "your Nimble is one size smaller": its Tireless Perk keeps its Nimble the same size.

READ ALOUD

The mirror is **Bulky**, which means one of you can carry it. While you do, you can't use the Mask, your Nimble is one size smaller, and every move takes your action in two Turns in a row. After the first you're somewhere in between, and you arrive when you act in the second.

And a mirror that size gets noticed. From now on, Suspicion goes up by 1 at the end of every Turn until it's out of town. You can put it down any time, except when you've been caught and are running for it, but only giving it up for good stops the noise.

If Dracula is in the shop, the mirror shows the counter, the dog, the biscuit, and everybody except him (flavour only). Taking the mirror back up after it's set down is an action. Abandoned, it stays where it is, makes no more noise, and can't be taken again.

## The Lock-up

**Always watched.** The first time anyone arrives who isn't a captive, make a Tell check. A captive's arrival doesn't count. For rescue and slipping free, see When It Happens.

READ ALOUD

The lock-up is a squat stone hut behind the square, with one barred door, one barred window, and a constable asleep in a chair outside with his hat over his eyes.

## The Way Out

**Always watched.** The first time anyone comes back here, make a Tell check. Only when everyone who isn't locked up is here may one of them roll.

READ ALOUD

The humpbacked bridge at the edge of town. Families are crossing it with lanterns, heading home; beyond it the path climbs into the woods and up to the castle.

If anyone is in the lock-up, read this before anyone rolls.

**READ ALOUD**

Anyone still in the lock-up when you cross is left behind. Are you sure you're all here?

### THE WAY OUT WATCHED

**One of you rolls for everybody. Sly to slip across with the crowd, or Nimble to go along under the bridge. Or Brawn, the loud way: barge straight through. Difficulty 6. Watched.**

**Success or Cost:** You're across, and the woods close behind you. (The Cost here costs nothing. Even if this roll takes Suspicion to the Limit, they're out, and nobody runs. Turn to Part Three.)

**Trouble:** A dad with a lantern lifts it high, right into your face, and screams. (Suspicion +1, and the roller is caught in a local chase. The way out can be rolled only once a Turn, so the party tries again next Turn.)





PART TWO

# When It Happens

## A Cost

The roller does it, but you pick one cost. Never pick one that costs nothing right then, such as Suspicion +1 on a roll, or a group check, that already raised it (an overdraw's +2 doesn't count here, since it goes on top), "drop an item" from someone carrying nothing, or a lost Turn when nothing is waiting, or a smaller die when the roller's next roll is a d12 at its own Duty's place (the bigger die cancels it).

READ THE LINE ALOUD

| | |
|---|---|
| **Suspicion +1** | You do it, but somebody noticed something odd about you. Suspicion goes up by 1. |
| **Drop an item** | You do it, but in the scramble you drop something. It's lying right here. |
| **Lose a Turn** | You do it, but it takes forever. You miss your next go. |
| **Smaller die** | You do it, but you've twisted something. Your next roll's trait die is one size smaller. |

**Drop an item:** one item of loot the roller carries, which you pick, though never what this roll wins and never the mirror. It stays in this place, and picking up dropped items is an action. Mix the Costs up; a dropped item is the most fun, because someone has to come back for it.

A lost Turn still owed when the final flight starts is forgotten.

## Trouble

It doesn't happen, and Suspicion +1. Read the obstacle's Trouble line. If the obstacle is **watched**, the roller is caught, so turn to Caught. If not, that's all, and they can try again next Turn. One Perk changes this. The Invisible Man (Out of Sight) isn't caught unless he, or anyone where he is, carries loot or the mirror (Suspicion still +1).

## The Monster Shows

When the Monster d10 rolls higher than the trait die, Suspicion +2, whatever the result. Not on a tie, and never with the Mask. If an ability let them roll the Monster without risking Suspicion (the Werewolf's Good Dog, the Invisible Man's Unseen, some Gifts), its showing adds nothing. One Perk changes this, Dracula's Hypnotic Eyes, on his Charm rolls. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, the roll stands, and then Hyde takes over, free, even if an ability meant it added nothing. In a chase, a show counts towards the chase's one rise instead (Caught).

READ THE LINE ALOUD

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dracula** | His shadow stretches the wrong way across the street, and it has wings. |
| **The Creature** | It straightens to its full height, and keeps on straightening. |
| **The Mummy** | A bandage comes loose and unwinds, and unwinds, and there is nobody inside. |
| **The Werewolf** | There's fur, a great deal of fur, and rather a lot of teeth. |
| **The Invisible Man** | A glove waves cheerfully at someone, with nothing inside it. |
| **A Ghost** | It flickers, and for a moment the wall behind it shows through. |
| **A Witch** | Green sparks crackle off her fingertips, and every lantern in the street flares. |
| **Jekyll & Hyde** | The kindly doctor's face twists into somebody else's. |

## A Critical

A Success where both dice show the same number. Outside a chase, the roller gets back one charge it spent (never more than 3), so read the box. In a chase it counts as two Successes, and you say instead, "You leave them standing."

> READ ALOUD
>
> Perfect, as neat as anything you've ever done. If you've spent a charge tonight, you get one back.

## A Tell Check

Make one the first time anyone reaches a watched place, which means the florist, the carpenter, the tailor, the lock-up (not a captive's arrival) and the way out once anyone comes back to it. Each place is checked once a night. Wait until everyone moving there this Turn has arrived (if you're not sure who else is coming, ask), then roll a d6. On 4–6, a Tell goes off. Number the arrivals and roll a d6 to pick one (for two arrivals, 1–3 is the first and 4–6 the second; for three, 1–2, 3–4, 5–6; for more, reroll a number nobody has), and read its line. Suspicion +1, and that's its only effect. **The Witch's Familiar's Warning:** if she is among the arrivals, a Tell goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6.

READ THE LINE ALOUD

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dracula** | A dark shop window reflects the whole street, the lanterns and the crowd and the grinning turnips, and everyone in it but you. Someone looks from the window to you, and back again. |
| **The Creature** | You stand a head above the whole crowd, and no costume in the world hides it. A child on her father's shoulders looks you right in the eye. |
| **The Mummy** | You leave a trail of dust behind you, and a smell of old spices. A woman sniffs, frowns, and follows it with her eyes, all the way to you. |
| **The Werewolf** | Your eyebrows meet in the middle, and there's a little too much hair everywhere else. A man nudges his friend. "Good costume," the friend says. "Very good." |
| **The Invisible Man** | Bandages, goggles, a false nose, and then a sneeze, from nowhere at all. Three people say "Bless you" and look round for whoever sneezed. |
| **A Ghost** | The candles gutter as you drift in, and everybody's breath fogs. Someone pulls their shawl tighter and peers into the cold. |
| **A Witch** | Your black cat sits down in the middle of the floor and stares at people without blinking, and one by one, they stare back. |
| **Jekyll & Hyde** | One of your hands is a gentleman's. The other is hairy and knotted. Guess which one somebody just shook. |

## A Group Check

When two or more roll the florist's crowded shop floor in the same Turn. Everyone declares their trait, their die and any charges first, then all roll at once. Each gets past on its own result. Suspicion rises only once for the whole check, by the biggest single trigger among the rolls. Everyone who gets Trouble is caught together, and flees together on one Lead (Caught, below).

READ ALOUD

You go into the crowd together. Ready? Everybody roll at once.

## Caught: the Local Chase

Trouble at a watched obstacle. If that Trouble takes Suspicion to the Limit, there's no local chase: turn to The Final Flight, where the runner flees with everyone else. The whole chase, however many rounds, happens inside this Turn. While it lasts, the runner can't drop, abandon or hand over anything. With the Werewolf's Night Runner, fleeing alone when the chase starts, say the Lead starts at 2.

READ ALOUD

They've seen you. Somebody shouts, and somebody else grabs a broom. Run!

This is a chase. Your **Lead** starts at 1. Get it to 4 and you've lost them. If it drops to 0, they've cornered you. Every round, I'll tell you what the ground is like, and it gives you two traits to choose from. Roll one of them, with the Mask or the Monster, against the mob. Any ability of yours can make your die one size bigger instead, even one your card says never works in a chase, but nobody else can spend a charge on your roll. A Success puts your Lead up by 1. Trouble puts it down by 1. A Cost leaves it where it is. After six rounds it's over: a Lead of 2 or more and you're away, and anything less and they've got you.

Suspicion doesn't move until the chase is over. Then it goes up once: by 2 if your Monster showed at any point, or else by 1 if you had any Trouble in the chase, and not at all if neither. And at the start of any round, before anyone rolls, you can give up and let them take you, and everything you carry, to the lock-up.

1. **The Lead** starts at 1. With the Werewolf's Night Runner, fleeing alone when the chase starts, it starts at 2.
2. **The mob's Difficulty** is 8 plus half the Suspicion, rounded down, at most 11, worked out when the chase starts (after the rise from the roll that got them caught). It stays the same for the whole chase. Suspicion 0–1: 8 · 2–3: 9 · 4–5: 10 · 6–8: 11. With the Mummy's Fear the Curse, if it flees alone when the chase starts, 1 lower.
3. **Each round,** roll a d6 on the ground table below and read the line. The runner picks one of its two traits, and the Mask or the Monster (carrying the mirror: no Mask, and Nimble one size smaller, though not the Creature's). Abilities go on the runner's own roll only, with nobody else's charges, and any may be spent as a raise instead. No Castle Duty in a chase.
4. **Move the Lead:** a Success +1 (a Critical +2), a Cost no change, Trouble –1.
5. **One chase, one rise.** Note the biggest trigger among the chase's rolls (Trouble +1, the Monster showing +2). When the chase ends, add it to Suspicion, with +2 more for each overdraw (one per runner).
6. **The Weakness:** from round 1 for Dracula and a Ghost, from round 3 for everyone else, the runner's trait die is one size smaller to the end of the chase. Read its line when it starts. A bigger die from an ability cancels it for that roll.
7. **Escape at 4** puts them back where they were caught, with this Turn used up. **Cornered at 0**, they're captured (below). **After round 6,** a Lead of 2 or more escapes, and less is cornered. A runner may also **give up** at the start of any round, once the ground is read and before anyone rolls: captured, no roll. A chase given up before anyone has rolled raises nothing.
8. **If the rise brings Suspicion to the Limit,** turn to The Final Flight once the chase is settled. A runner who escaped joins the flight; anyone cornered, or who gave up, is in the lock-up and stays there. If that leaves nobody outside the lock-up, nobody runs. Turn to Part Three, where the year is Forked.

**Caught together.** When several get Trouble in the same group check, they're caught together. Each of them rolls each round, in any order they like, and the Lead moves once for the round by the majority rule (The Final Flight). The chase still rises once, when it ends, by the biggest trigger among all their rolls. Anyone may give up at the start of a round, and the rest carry on. A Perk that changes a local chase only works for someone fleeing alone when the chase starts, so a fellow runner giving up later doesn't bring it in.

## The Ground (d6, every round of any chase)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **The crowded square** | Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through. **Sly, Charm.** |
| 2 | **Back alleys** | Duck, dodge, double back. **Nimble, Sly.** |
| 3 | **The market stalls** | Overturn a cart, vault a stall. **Brawn, Nimble.** |
| 4 | **Over the rooftops** | Climb, jump, find a way down. **Nimble, Wits.** |
| 5 | **The festival parade** | Join in: you're in costume, after all. **Charm, Sly.** |
| 6 | **A dead end** | Break through, or think fast. **Brawn, Wits.** |

## The Mob Brings Your Weakness

READ THE LINE ALOUD

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Dracula: Garlic** | Round 1 | Someone at the front is waving a string of garlic like a lantern. |
| **The Creature: Fire** | Round 3 | Somebody has gone and lit the torches. |
| **The Mummy: A Loose Thread** | Round 3 | A small boy has hold of a loose end, and he is not letting go. |
| **The Werewolf: Hounds** | Round 3 | Behind the mob, someone has let the hunting dogs out. |
| **The Invisible Man: Flour** | Round 3 | A bag of flour bursts all over you, and there you are. |
| **A Ghost: Cold Iron** | Round 1 | The street is suddenly full of cold iron. Horseshoes, railings, and is that a poker from somebody's fire? |
| **A Witch: Rowan** | Round 3 | Old Granny Mott has a sprig of rowan, and she's holding it up at you. |
| **Jekyll & Hyde: A Familiar Face** | Round 3 | "Doctor Jekyll? Is that you?" |

## Captured

Cornered in a local chase, or gave up. The town takes back everything the captive carried, the mirror included. All of it is gone for the night, and nobody can take any of it again. Put the captive's token in the lock-up.

> READ ALOUD
>
> Hands grab you from every side, and somebody sits on you. When you get your breath back, you're in the lock-up, and the constable is very pleased with himself. Everything you were carrying is gone.

If this chase's rise brought Suspicion to the Limit, stop here: nobody can slip free or come back for the captive now. If every Entity is now in the lock-up, the night is over; turn to Part Three, where the year is Forked. Otherwise, read on.

> READ ALOUD
>
> From next Turn, once a Turn, you can try to slip free. Or the others can come and get you. Anyone still in here when they leave town is left behind.

A captive can't pick anything up or be handed anything, but can still spend charges on any roll at the lock-up, whether its own, a rescuer's or another captive's.

## Rescue and Slipping Free

**A RESCUE** WATCHED

**Anyone not held, at the lock-up (getting there is a move). Sly to sneak past the constable, or Brawn, the loud way: tear the door off. Difficulty 10. Watched.**

**Success or Cost:** every captive there is free (pick a Cost as usual). The freed act again next Turn, from the lock-up. If this roll's Suspicion reaches the Limit, they're still free, and they join the final flight.

> READ ALOUD
>
> The way is clear, and the constable snores on.

**Trouble:** Suspicion +1, and the rescuer is caught in a local chase.

> READ ALOUD
>
> The constable's hat falls off, and underneath it he is wide awake.

**SLIPPING FREE** WATCHED

**The captive, once a Turn, from the Turn after its capture. Sly or Nimble, or Brawn, the loud way. Difficulty 10. Watched.**

**Success:** free, and acts again next Turn, from the lock-up. If this roll's Suspicion reaches the Limit, it's still free, and it joins the final flight. **A Cost:** nothing happens. **Trouble:** Suspicion +1, but no chase.

> READ ALOUD
>
> The bars, it turns out, are only a suggestion.

The lock-up is watched, so Dracula's Mesmerise works on both. A captive may also slip free by a way of its own (its card's ability, at a Difficulty 2 lower). A rescue frees only those held at that moment.

## Dropping, Picking Up and Handing Over

An Entity may drop its own loot, or the mirror it carries, any time, free, except while it's caught (until its chase ends). Dropped things stay in that place; dropped between places, they stay at the place it left, and an Entity that sets the mirror down there is back at that place too. Anyone there may pick up any number of dropped items, as their action for a Turn. Loot can be handed to anyone in the same place, free, any time, though not while caught, and never to a captive.

## Suspicion Rising

Flavour only. Read each line the first time Suspicion reaches or passes that number, so the players feel the town waking up. At the Limit, skip them and turn to The Final Flight. With five players (Limit 8), read each line at the number in brackets.

| READ THE LINE ALOUD | |
|---|---|
| **3 (2)** | Somewhere a dog starts barking, and doesn't stop. |
| **5 (4)** | The church bell starts ringing, though it isn't the hour. In the square, someone says, quite loudly, "Those aren't costumes." |
| **7 (6)** | Pitchforks are coming out of sheds, and nobody is pretending they're "for the parade" any more. |
| **8 (7)** | Lanterns are gathering in the square. One more thing, just one, and they'll come for you. |

## Overdraw

At zero charges an Entity can still use an ability, paying Suspicion +2 instead, on top of the roll's other rise (in a local chase, on top of the chase's one rise, and only once a chase). In the final flight it costs a smaller trait die instead (The Final Flight).

## The End of a Turn, and Dawn

At the end of every Turn, if the mirror has been taken and is still in town (carried or set down, not lost or abandoned), Suspicion +1. Then move the Turn marker.

| READ THE LINE ALOUD | |
|---|---|
| **Start of Turn 10** | Over the woods, the sky is turning grey. The fiddles are slowing down. |
| **Start of Turn 12** | This is the last Turn before dawn. The first birds are singing. Anyone still in town when the sun comes up will have to run for it. |
| **End of Turn 12** | The sun comes up over Hallowby, and every costume in the street turns back into a person. All except yours, that is. |

After the end of Turn 12, everyone still in town who isn't locked up goes to The Final Flight. If every Entity is in the lock-up at once, the night ends there. Turn to Part Three: the year is Forked.





PART TWO

# The Final Flight

When Suspicion reaches the Limit, or dawn comes with anyone still in town. Stop wherever you are, even in the middle of a Turn. If it was a local chase's rise that brought it, anyone who escaped that chase runs too, and anyone cornered in it, or who gave up, is in the lock-up. Captives stay in the lock-up. If every Entity is in the lock-up, nobody runs. Turn to Part Three, where the year is Forked.

**READ ALOUD**

That's it. Hallowby has had enough. The bells are ringing and the fiddles have stopped. Every lantern in town is turning your way, and with them come pitchforks, rolling pins, the whole costume contest, and old Granny Mott at the front.

Run for the castle. All of you, together, right now.

**READ ALOUD**

This is the **final flight**. Everyone who isn't locked up runs together, from wherever you are.

Your Lead starts at **2**. Get it to **5** and you're home. If it drops to 0, they've got you, and you're forked.

The masks are off now. Everyone rolls the Monster, and Suspicion doesn't matter any more. Every round I roll the ground, and it gives you two traits to choose from. Each of you rolls one of them against the mob, and you can spend charges on each other's rolls. Any ability can now be spent just to make someone's trait die one size bigger, whatever it usually does, even if your card says it never works in a chase.

Then we count. More Successes than Trouble, your Lead goes up by 1, or by 2 if you're two or more ahead. More Trouble than Successes, it goes down the same way. Level, it stays. A Cost counts for neither, and a Critical counts as two Successes.

Anything you drop now stays in Hallowby.

## Running It

1. **Who runs:** every Entity who isn't captured. **The Lead** starts at 2. Escape at 5. Cornered at 0 means Forked.
2. **The mob's Difficulty is 10,** however many run. Suspicion has stopped, and nothing raises it now.
3. **Each round:** roll a d6 on the ground table (When It Happens) and read its line. Each runner picks one of its two traits. The Monster d10 only. Carrying the mirror makes Nimble one size smaller (not the Creature's: it's Tireless). Abilities may go on anyone's roll, and any ability may be spent as a raise instead of doing what it usually does (one raise per roll). Everyone rolls, in any order the party likes.
4. **The majority rule:** count the Successes (a Critical counts as two) and the Trouble; Costs count for neither. If Successes are ahead by 1, the Lead goes up 1, and by 2 or more, it goes up 2. If Trouble is ahead, it goes down the same way. Level means no change. For example, a Success, a Critical, a Cost and a Trouble make 3 Successes to 1 Trouble, so the Lead goes up 2.
5. **The Weakness:** the flight is a new chase for everyone, even someone who came straight from a local chase. From round 1 for Dracula and a Ghost, from round 3 for everyone else, the trait die is one size smaller to the end of the flight. Read its line. A bigger die from an ability cancels it for that roll.
6. **Overdraw** now costs a smaller die instead of Suspicion. From the overdrawer's own next roll to the end of the flight, its trait die is one size smaller, on top of any Weakness. Once per flight each, Weakness or not.

## Home

The Lead reaches 5. Everyone in the flight is home, with everything they carry. Anyone still in the lock-up is left behind.

> **READ ALOUD**
>
> The last pitchfork falls behind in the woods, and the castle door slams shut. Somewhere far below, Hallowby is still shouting at the trees.
>
> You made it. Let's see what you brought home.

Turn to Part Three.

## Forked

The Lead reaches 0. The year's result is Forked, whatever the party carries. Turn to Part Three and read only the Forked line.

> **READ ALOUD**
>
> They've cornered you at the bottom of the hill, with the castle's windows glowing just above the trees. The lanterns close in, and up come the pitchforks.
>
> You got forked.





PART THREE

# How the Year Went

About 5–10 minutes. An item, or the mirror, is home if an Entity who got out of town carries it, whether that Entity left by the way out or escaped the final flight. Find the result, then read its line.

READ THE RESULT'S LINE ALOUD

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Grand Year** | A Win, and the mirror came home too. | A year of plenty. The new piece goes in the great hall, and everyone pretends it was always there. |
| **Win** | The wine came home, and no more than one of the other three items is missing. | Full larders, warm fires. The castle creaks happily through another year. |
| **Partial** | Not a Win, but at least 2 of the 4 items came home. Without the wine, a Partial at best. | The castle gets by, just. Someone has to sleep in the draughty tower. |
| **Bust** | 0 or 1 of the 4 items came home. | A long, thin year, and a lot of arguing about whose fault it was. |
| **Forked** | Cornered in the final flight, or every Entity in the lock-up at once. | The town tells the story for years. Next Lantern Night, the bells ring a little louder. |

**Left behind:** work out the result first, then drop it one step for each Entity left in the lock-up, so a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. It never drops below Bust.

Then, unless the result is Forked, read one line for each item that didn't come home. If the nightshade didn't come home, or the year is Forked, end the goodnight's first sentence at "spoons".

READ THE LINE ALOUD

| | |
|---|---|
| **The wine (food and drink)** | Turnip soup every night until spring. |
| **The nightshade (plants and seeds)** | Nothing grows but nettles, and the nettles win. |
| **The hinges (tools and hardware)** | Every door in the castle creaks, sticks or falls off. |
| **The cape (cloth and costumes)** | Next year's disguises are held together with string and hope. |

## Goodnight

READ ALOUD

And that was Lantern Night in Hallowby. Somewhere down the hill, a town is counting its spoons, and a florist is wondering where the nightshade went.

Happy Halloween.

Want more? The rulebook has three more towns, and tables to roll your own.

TO HAND OUT

# The Eight Entities



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

## Dracula

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Mesmerise** 1 CHARGE

At a watched obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at a Difficulty 2 lower; Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive. Never in a chase. *He bends a mind with a look.*

**Gift: Shape of the Night (Bat)** 1 CHARGE

Roll Nimble instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *He flits up to the window.*

**Perk: Hypnotic Eyes** ALWAYS ON

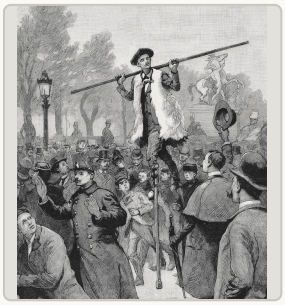
On Charm rolls, the Monster shows only if it beats your trait die by 2 or more.

**Castle Duty** (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

**Weakness: Garlic.** Always (from round 1): in any chase, from its first round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Every kitchen in town has some, and the mob knows it.*

**Tell: No Reflection.** *A shop window shows everyone but him.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



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## Frankenstein's Creature

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Brute Force** 1 CHARGE

Roll Brawn instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.*

**Gift: Made, Not Born (Mountain Stride)** 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive. Never in a chase. *He bounds over walls the way he crossed the glaciers.*

**Perk: Tireless** ALWAYS ON

Carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.

**Castle Duty** (default): Handyman, who shops for tools and hardware. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

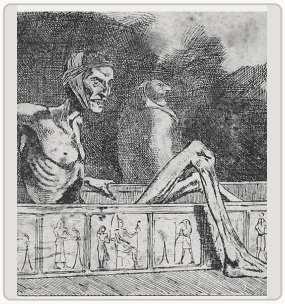
**Weakness: Fire.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone has to light the torches.*

**Tell: Head and Shoulders.** *He stands a head above the whole crowd, and no costume hides it.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

# The Mummy

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Ancient Lore** 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It knew this trick three thousand years ago.*

**Gift: Secrets of the Tomb (Royal Bearing)** 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive. Never in a chase. *They still bow to a pharaoh.*

**Perk: Fear the Curse** ALWAYS ON

If you're fleeing alone when your local chase starts, its mob's Difficulty is 1 lower (after the cap of 11). *Nobody wants to get too close.*

**Castle Duty** (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

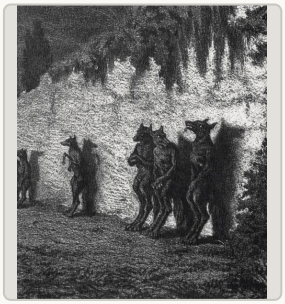
**Weakness: A Loose Thread.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Once someone grabs a loose end, it all starts to unravel.*

**Tell: Dust and Spice.** *A trail of dust and a smell of old spices wherever it walks.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

# The Werewolf

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Good Dog** 1 CHARGE

Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual. *If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.*

**Gift: The Wolf Within (Keen Nose)** 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It smells the way in.*

**Perk: Night Runner** ALWAYS ON

If you're fleeing alone when your local chase starts, it starts at Lead 2.

**Castle Duty** (default): Gardener, who shops for plants and seeds. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

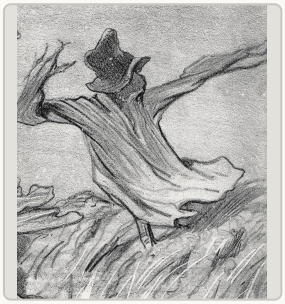
**Weakness: Hounds.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone lets the hunting dogs out.*

**Tell: Eyebrows That Meet.** *Brows that meet in the middle, and a little too much hair everywhere.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



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# The Invisible Man

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Unseen** 1 CHARGE

Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual. *When the Monster shows, there's nothing to see.*

**Gift: A Scientist's Tricks (Through the Gap)** 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive. Never in a chase. *He slips through as the door swings shut.*

**Perk: Out of Sight** ALWAYS ON

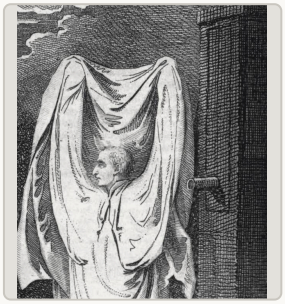
Trouble at a watched obstacle doesn't get you caught unless you, or anyone in the same place, carries loot or furniture. It still raises Suspicion. *They can't see you, but they can see a floating candlestick.*

**Castle Duty** (default): Tailor, who shops for cloth and costumes. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

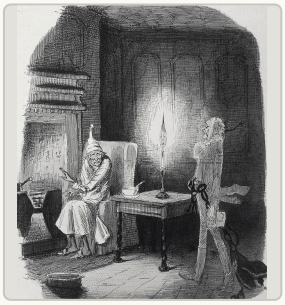
**Weakness: Flour.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone throws a bag of flour, and there he is.*

**Tell: Bandages and Goggles.** *A wrapped head, dark goggles, a false nose, and a sneeze from nowhere.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



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# A Ghost

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Through the Wall** 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Sly, roll Sly at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive. Never in a chase. Not while you carry loot or furniture: nothing you carry passes through. *It drifts in where there's no door.*

**Gift: Haunting (Chill)** 1 CHARGE

Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *A sudden cold, and fingers fumble.*

**Perk: Spectral** ALWAYS ON

Group ways in don't stop you: no roll and no action. If one is the location's only obstacle, you take the item, and if the party picks the other way in, you're still past. Not while you carry loot or furniture.

**Castle Duty** (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

**Weakness: Cold Iron.** Always (from round 1): in any chase, from its first round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Horseshoes, railings, a poker from the fire: every street has some.*

**Tell: Cold Spot.** *Candles gutter and breath fogs wherever it drifts.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



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# A Witch

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: Hedge Spell** 1 CHARGE

Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *Old village magic: a muttered word, a pinch of salt, and luck leans her way.*

**Gift: Witchcraft (A Potion for That)** 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *There's a potion for everything.*

**Perk: Familiar's Warning** ALWAYS ON

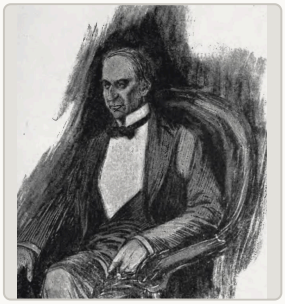
When you arrive somewhere that gets a Tell check, alone or with others, a Tell goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6. That covers everyone arriving with you. *The cat warns you.*

**Castle Duty** (default): Cook, who shops for food and drink. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

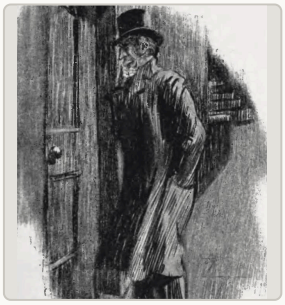
**Weakness: Rowan.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *A sprig of rowan, the old charm against witches: somebody's grandmother always has one.*

**Tell: A Black Cat.** *A black cat follows her everywhere and stares at people.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

# Jekyll & Hyde

**Jekyll:** Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

**Hyde:** Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

**Charges:** ◯◯◯ **(3: one per use of an ability)**

**Signature: The Draught** 1 CHARGE

Before one of your rolls, change form: Jekyll to Hyde or back (each has its own dice). The new form lasts until the next draught. Each raid starts with Jekyll. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, that roll stands and Hyde takes over straight after it, free, until a draught changes him back. He does even when an ability, his own or a friend's, meant the Monster raised no Suspicion.

**Gift: The Other Self (Doctor's Bag)** 1 CHARGE

Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *The right instrument for the job.*

**Perk: Practised Hand** ALWAYS ON

Changing back to Jekyll costs no charge.

**Castle Duty** (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper. Your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls at a location whose item is that kind (never in a chase).

**Weakness: A Familiar Face.** Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone in the mob recognises the good doctor.*

**Tell: The Wrong Hand.** *One hand a gentleman's, the other hairy and knotted.*

Spend a charge before rolling, on your own roll or a friend's in the same place (in a local chase, only your own). One raise per roll. In a chase, any ability can be a raise. With no charges left you can still overdraw: Suspicion +2, on top of the roll's other rise (once in a local chase; in the final flight, once, your trait die one size smaller from your next roll instead).

# The Night's Tracker

Lantern Night in Hallowby · Easy · put a coin or a token on each track

## Suspicion (at 9, or 8 with five players, the final flight starts)

| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | **9** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Trouble +1 · the Monster shows +2 · the loud way +1 · a Cost picked as Suspicion +1 · overdraw +2 · a Tell +1 · the mirror +1 each Turn. One roll, one rise, by its biggest; overdraw +2 on top. A local chase rises once, when it ends. Local mob, set when the chase starts: 8 + half the Suspicion (0–1: 8 · 2–3: 9 · 4–5: 10 · 6–8: 11).

## Turns (dawn when the 12th ends)

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | **12** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Each Turn: everyone rolls, moves, picks up or waits. Tell check when anyone first arrives at a watched place. End of Turn: the mirror +1 once taken.

## The Lead

| **0** | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

0: cornered. Local chase: start at 1, escape at 4, after round 6 a Lead of 2+ escapes, one overdraw, give up at the start of a round. Final flight: start at 2, escape at 5, mob 10, the Monster only, the majority rule. Any chase: any ability as a raise.

## The List

| | |
|---|---|
| ☐ **A cask of red wine** | essential · the tavern cellar · carried by: |
| ☐ **A pot of nightshade** | the florist · carried by: |
| ☐ **Hinges that creak properly** | the carpenter · carried by: |
| ☐ **A new cape** | the tailor · carried by: |
| ☐ **The gilt mirror** | the tailor, behind the dog · Bulky · carried by: |

## Castle Duties

Cook (the wine) _____ Gardener (the nightshade) _____

Handyman (the hinges) _____ Tailor (the cape) _____ Butler / Librarian _____

## The Places

| | |
|---|---|
| **Tell check done** | ☐ florist ☐ carpenter ☐ tailor ☐ lock-up ☐ way out |
| **Way in chosen** | tavern ☐ geese ☐ trapdoor · florist ☐ crowd ☐ drainpipe · carpenter ☐ door ☐ wall · tailor ☐ Mrs Pinch ☐ window |
| **Beaten** | ☐ tavern way in ☐ back room · ☐ florist way in · ☐ carpenter way in ☐ watchman · ☐ tailor way in ☐ guard dog |
| **Owed** | smaller die: · lost Turn: |
| **In the lock-up** | |